

Summary

- **CompTIA Security+** and **BTL1** certified, demonstrating a strong foundation in cyber security principles, including **threat detection**, **incident response** and **security monitoring**.
- Spearheaded the development of security policies and frameworks, achieving **IASME Cyber Essentials** certification for organisations strengthening their overall cyber security posture.
- Hands-on experience with SIEMs notably **SPLUNK** and **Sentinel** from BTL1 Certification and personal projects.
- Strong understanding of **Active Directory** architecture, administration including user account management and security principals
- Confident managing and overseeing **AD**, **Entra ID** and **M365 Administration** from IT Field Engineer experience
- Proficiency in networking, installation/patching and configuration of network devices such as switches, firewalls and access points
- Advanced knowledge of both **Windows** and **Mac OS X** operating systems and a strong understanding of UNIX platforms

Experience

July 2024 – Present

Cyber Security Compliance Analyst

Inspire ICT Ltd

As a Cyber Security Compliance Analyst, I am responsible for ensuring that organisational systems, processes and policies comply with relevant security standards. My role involves conducting risk assessments, auditing security practices and collaborating across teams to ensure compliance with stakeholder requirements and GDPR. I play a key role in developing and implementing cyber security SLAs, policies, and procedures, ensuring continuous improvement in the organisation's security posture.

- Conducted regular audits and assessments to identify vulnerabilities and ensure continuous adherence to evolving cyber security standards.
- Addressed cyber security audit findings from school trusts and stakeholders, ensuring compliance with their requirements across supported schools and educational facilities.
- Developed and enforced cyber security policies tailored to the specific needs of educational institutions.
- Collaborated with technical teams to ensure smooth integration and operation of the newly implemented security measures.

Sept 2022 – June 2024

IT Field Engineer

Inspire ICT Ltd

During my time as a field engineer, I was responsible for providing on-site technical support for 7 different sites on a weekly rota, each site utilised a wide range technologies, giving me a broad and comprehensive experience across various systems and environments. My responsibilities included administering Active Directory, managing Azure cloud services, configuring and maintaining Windows Server environments, managing security monitoring tools and orchestrating intricate network setups.

- **Sophos Intercept X (EDR)** to monitor, oversee and respond to threats ensuring the security and integrity of IT systems.
- **Sophos Phish Threat** to create phishing templates and run phishing awareness campaigns.
- Managed mobile devices using **Cisco Meraki MDM**, configured profiles and ensured compliance with security policies.
- Experience with **Active Directory** architecture and administration, including user account management and security principals
- Co-led the planning and implementation phase of **Windows 11** upgrades to **5,000+ devices** across **65+ locations**.
- Maintained **Windows Server** environments, including configuration, monitoring, and troubleshooting to ensure optimal system functionality and uptime.
- Proficiency in networking, installation and configuration of network devices such as switches, firewalls and access points.
- Implemented and managed **Group Policies** to enforce security and configuration settings, manage user rights, utilising **GPOs** and **GPPs**.
- Strong interpersonal and communication skills, working with end-users to provide technical support and resolve end user issues in a **help desk** setting in a timely manner.

Certifications

August 2024

Blue Team Level 1

Security Blue Team

July 2024

Vulnerability Management

Security Blue Team

May 2024

CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701)

CompTIA

Education

Sept 2019 - Jun 2022, BSc (Hons) Computer Science, Brunel University, London

Specialisation: Cyber security

Sept 2015 to July 2017, A Levels, City and Islington College, London

Level 3 Extended Diploma in IT Practitioners: D*D*D*

Technical Projects

Security Blue Team Level 1:

SIEM and Log analysis – Completed hands-on SIEM labs as part of the Security Blue Team Level 1 certification, focusing on leveraging **Splunk** for comprehensive security monitoring and incident response.

- Collected, normalised and analysed logs from diverse sources, including firewalls (**FortiGate**), IDS/IPS and endpoint protection systems.
- Developed custom **dashboards** and visualisations in **Splunk** to effectively communicate security metrics and incident trends.
- Employed Splunk's **search query language (SPL)** to investigate security incidents, create queries and extract actionable insights from data.

Phishing Analysis – Completed labs consisting of categorising phishing emails based on key indicators, retrieving email, web and file artifacts from emails and creating **reports** based on an email's malicious intent.

- Used **PhishTool** to analyse phishing emails and collect email artifacts such as file hashes and header details
- Visualisation tools such as **URL2PNG** and **URLScan** to safely assess potentially malicious URLs
- Analysed IP addresses, URLs, domains and file hashes using **VirusTotal**

Digital Forensics – Hands on labs covering digital evidence collection, Windows and Linux investigations.

- Forensic tool **Autopsy** for in-depth forensic analysis, including file recovery, timeline creation, and identifying artifacts on digital storage devices
- **FTK Imager** to create forensic images of digital storage devices and ensure data integrity through hashing
- Employed **KABE** for comprehensive memory analysis and investigation of volatile data in live systems
- **Scalpel** in Linux for carving files from disk images based on file headers and footers, recovering deleted data for forensic examination
- **Volatility 3** to analyse memory dumps from systems

Networking/Linux Project - A project using **Ubuntu** to capture and investigate network packets using **Wireshark**

- Confident in navigating and using commands on Linux based OS such as **Ubuntu**
- Set up a **virtual network** to study network protocols using **Oracle VM VirtualBox**
- Experience in using Wireshark **packet sniffer** tool and **protocol analyser** to examine network traffic
- A firm understanding of network concepts including TCP/IP protocols

Additional personal projects can be found at: <https://nathanndefo.github.io/>

Interests

Technology

- Regularly watch podcasts on cyber security and cybercrime, such as Darknet Diaries exploring incidents and trends.
- Eager to expand knowledge in cyber security through certifications, self-study and hands-on experience.

Other

- Enjoy the outdoors, regularly find the time to hike, camp and fish.
- Small business in photography focusing on portraits and cars.